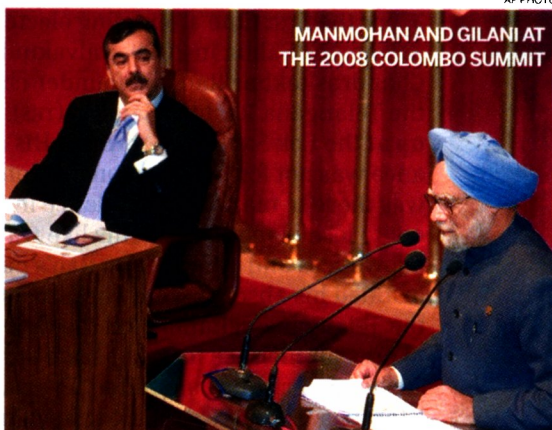


DELHI | Green Peace

SAARC summits are usually dull and boring affairs with a ritualistic joint statement, customary pledges and a sideshow of Indo-Pak cordiality. But the one in Bhutan on April 28 may well be the first Green summit, dedicated to action on climate change. Climate change is the issue that concerns most South Asian nations, with countries like Maldives running the risk of vanishing with rising sea levels. Bhutan is the only country to have enshrined in its constitution that 70 per cent of the country will be under forest cover. While the summit is important, it is a logistical nightmare for the tiny country. Each delegation will be housed in Thimpu's ministerial enclave and at the city's only five-star hotel. Even Prime Minister Manmohan Singh will be taking



a lean delegation because of restrictions on aircraft in the small airstrip at Paro near Thimpu. Going by the past record, SAARC summits have witnessed sparks on the sidelines. This time Islamabad wants a meeting between Manmohan and Pakistan Prime Minister Yousaf Raza Gilani, but this time around Delhi isn't warming up to the idea. *by Saurabh Shukla*

BUZZ OF THE WEEK

A.R. Rahman has agreed to cut his fee for composing the theme song for the Commonwealth Games from Rs 15 crore to Rs 5 crore, but the organisers smell a greater bargain. Will Rahman rock the capital for cheap?

LUCKNOW | The Wrong Moves



On the birth anniversary of Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar, Rahul Gandhi launched the Congress's biggest mass mobilisation seen in Uttar Pradesh in two decades. The flagging off

of 10 rath yatras from Ambedkar Nagar on April 14 aimed at covering all 403 Assembly constituencies in Uttar Pradesh. The rath yatras will roll non-stop through the state for 100 days. Little did the Congress general secretary know that all was not well in the background. To start with, the booklet released on 125 years of the Congress had no mention of Ambedkar. The icing on the cake came from Bulandshahar on April 19, where the yatra organisers reportedly called a group of dancing girls from Haryana to attract crowds. They were so "vulgar that some women party workers had to leave the venue," said a state Congress leader. *by Subhash Mishra*

MUMBAI | Sun Shine

In a few months, all the hoardings in Mumbai may be lit up using solar energy instead of electricity. Energy Minister Ganesh Naik seeks to make the use of solar energy mandatory for all billboards and hoardings in the city. Naik has sought information on the quantum of power consumed by each hoarding and the availability of space for installing the equipment from the city's civic body. The idea was

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HOARDINGS IN MUMBAI MAY BE LIT UP BY SOLAR POWER

proposed by Mumbai's former mayor Shubha Raul during her tenure. It will save the Government 15,000 units of power everyday in the city. "Most of the power in Mumbai is generated by thermal power plants. With the power shortage, the government doesn't really have a choice other than using solar energy," says activist Sachin Singh from Greenpeace. *by Mitali Patel*